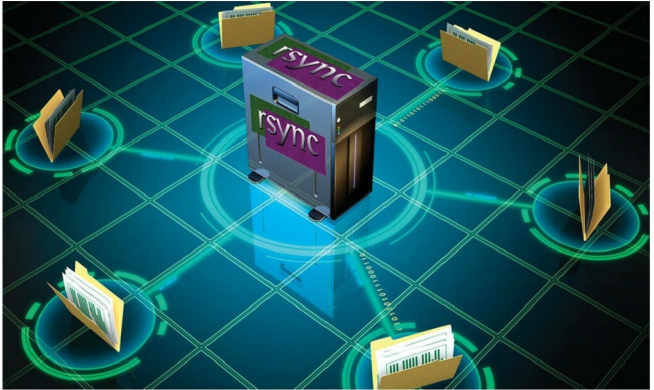


Rsync, the Remote-Update Utility

The Rsync utility greatly simplifies backup tasks. Its many options provide more control over the sync process. Rsync is one of the many tools you would definitely like to have in your arsenal. So explores its many features in this article.



For any computer user, data loss or data corruption can be a really bad experience but for professionals like sysadmins, it's a nightmare. It is very important to back up data so that it can be restored in the event of data loss. Manual copying is a tedious job and hence there are several tools available for easing this task. Rsync (remote sync) is a remote and local file synchronisation tool. It can copy locally, to or from another host over any remote shell, and to or from a remote Rsync daemon. It supports copying links, devices, owners, groups and even permissions. It is also faster than most of the other synchronisation tools as it uses the remote-update protocol which allows the transfer of only the differences between two sets of files, i.e., it copies data only by moving those portions of a file that have changed. It also provides various options that allow us to control the synchronisation. Rsync is a very powerful utility and also a lot of fun to work with. In this article, we will explore this powerful utility.

Getting Rsync

Rsync is a popular tool and it comes, by default, in most of the Linux and UNIX-like systems.

To install Rsync on Debian or Ubuntu Linux, type the following command:

```
$ sudo apt-get install rsync
```

To install on rpm based Linux, type the following command:

```
# yum install rsync
```



Note: All the examples in this tutorial are demonstrated on Ubuntu Mate 14.10

Basic syntax

If you have used any of the file copying utilities (FTP, SSH, etc) earlier, you will find the Rsync syntax very familiar. The syntax is something like what follows:

```
# rsync options source destination
```